

Digital Literacy Rate

The digital literacy rate is defined as the total number of digitally literate individuals expressed as a percentage of the total population aged 5 years and over.

Table 7.12 : Computer and Digital Literacy Rate by Sector, 2024

Sector	Computer Literacy rate (%)	Digital Literacy Rate (%)
Sri Lanka	34.7	67.6
Urban*	47.0	76.8
Rural	33.0	66.4
Estate Rural**	14.9	50.2

*Although the 2024 Census collected information separately as urban and estate urban, here the two categories are combined and shown as urban.

** The sector identified as 'Estate' in the 2012 Census corresponds to the 'Estate Rural' category in the 2024 Census.

According to Table 7.12 the computer literacy rate for the population aged five years and over stands at 34.7 percent, while the digital literacy rate is reported at 67.6 percent. The Urban sector exhibits a higher computer literacy rate relative to other sectors. The digital literacy rate is higher than the computer literacy rate in every sector.

Table 7.13 : Computer and Digital Literacy Rate by District, 2024

District	Population Aged 5 years & over	Computer Literacy Rate	Digital Literacy Rate
Sri Lanka	20,566,680	34.7	67.6
Colombo	2,271,290	51.0	78.7
Gampaha	2,319,190	42.7	73.7
Kalutara	1,239,745	37.1	69.1
Kandy	1,382,499	38.5	69.0
Matale	496,910	31.4	65.7
Nuwara Eliya	680,431	23.9	56.4
Galle	1,039,455	36.1	67.1
Matara	792,812	35.0	65.9
Hambantota	631,619	30.1	64.1
Jaffna	559,228	29.0	66.5
Mannar	114,635	19.5	62.0
Vavuniya	161,045	25.4	67.9
Mullaitivu	114,411	20.4	66.5
Kilinochchi	127,536	22.1	66.3
Batticaloa	550,033	23.8	65.8
Ampara	688,172	27.4	64.4
Trincomalee	407,995	22.2	65.2
Kurunegala	1,671,998	34.1	65.6
Puttalam	766,720	26.1	66.6
Anuradhapura	903,486	30.7	66.6
Polonnaruwa	420,411	27.4	64.2
Badulla	822,169	29.7	59.8
Moneragala	494,374	26.4	60.0
Rathnapura	1,084,599	30.3	62.2
Kegalle	825,917	34.5	64.5

As given in Table 7.13 Colombo District records the highest computer literacy rate in Sri Lanka, with Gampaha and Kandy districts ranking second and third, respectively. The lowest computer literacy rate is reported in Mannar District. Notably, the digital literacy rate remains above 50 percent in every district